

CNIT 13600 Personal Computing Technology and Applications

Spring 2026 (last updated 12/12/2025)

This syllabus is subject to change with notice.

Course Information

CNIT 13600 Personal Computing Technology And Applications

CRN: 57718

Associated Term: Spring 2026

Levels: Graduate, Professional, Undergraduate

Distance Learning - Online Instructional Method

3.000 Credits

Type	Time	Where	Date Range	Schedule Type	Instructors
Class	Distance	Asynchronous Online Learning ONLINE	Jan 12, 2026 - May 02, 2026	Distance Learning	Henrietta Boowuo (P)

This course is offered via distance learning. Our primary point of contact for the course will be Brightspace. You will have access to a variety of materials, including programmed learning tutorials, on-line reading material, recommended readings beyond the assigned textbooks, homework exercises, discussion forums, and email contact with the instructor. Your exams will be administered through the Pearson myLab IT product online. Much of the textual material is also available as printed material for an additional fee, to aid those who wish to have a physical copy of the text. The paper textbooks can be ordered through Pearson myLab IT.

Advice for a successful semester:

- **Carefully read each and every email you receive from the instruction team (FYI – do not forward your Purdue mail as you will miss these announcements from Brightspace)**
- Maintain self-motivation and self-discipline
- Manage time effectively
- Be a self-learner/discoverer
- Set a specific time each week in your schedule for studying and completing the homework assignments
- Ask for help at cnit136help@purdue.edu if you get stuck on a task

Prerequisites None

Corequisites None

Instructor Contact Information

Course Instructor	Contact Information	Office Location	Office Hours
Henrietta Boowuo	hboowuo@purdue.edu cnit136help@purdue.edu	KNOY B17A	Thursdays 12:30-2:30 PM ONLINE • Emails are read 8am-5pm during weekdays and will be responded to within 24 hours. • You can also contact me via Teams.
Ernest Ofori-Mensah	eforime@purdue.edu cnit136help@purdue.edu	KNOY B17A	Tuesdays 12:30-2:30 PM KNOY B044 • Emails are read 8am-5pm during weekdays and will be responded to within 24 hours. You can also contact me via Teams.

Course Description and Theme

The ability to use a personal computer (PC) is essential to virtually all majors, jobs, and careers. The course is divided into two areas of learning. First, the lectures in this course are intended to teach you about personal computer concepts and applications. You will learn about different types of PCs, PC operating systems and user interfaces, popular classes of PC applications, and tools used to build PC applications. Second, the laboratory portion provides hands-on experience with some standard PC applications - specifically the *Microsoft Office Suite*. Make it your goal NOT to merely learn these packages. Your eventual employer(s) may use different packages. Therefore, be sure to learn:

- The concepts behind word processing, spreadsheets, etc.
- The types of problems to which each application can be applied
- The general problem solving approach

Learning Resources, Technology, & Texts

Information Technology used in this course

- You will need to use the fully installed version of Microsoft Office 365 – this software is free from Purdue IT. The instructions for installation are here on the Purdue Office 365 portal:
<https://it.purdue.edu/services/microsoft-office-365.php>
 - To install Office 365 on your computer, visit the Purdue Office 365 portal. Sign in with your Purdue email address and password. Select “Apps” then click the Install button on the top right of the page.
 - You **MUST** install the latest version of office 365. To address any challenges, please refer to the installation guide under the “start here” section on Brightspace.
- In this course we use Pearson myLab IT via Brightspace - **How to Register for our Course via Brightspace:** https://help.pearsoncmg.com/integration/cg/student/content/get_started.htm
 - The access code can either be purchased online directly (recommended) via the myLab IT link in Brightspace or at the bookstore. Price: \$159 directly -\$175 bookstores
 - **MyLab IT with Pearson eText Access Code for Exploring 2021 with Technology in Action 18e: Evans/Poatsy ISBN: 9780138103941**

Additional Information

- Submit your own work. **This is particularly important when writing your reflections.** If you use a source for support, include quotes and a citation. Academic dishonesty includes taking content directly from an Internet search, another person/entity, or AI/LLM technology such as ChatGPT (either directly or with modification) and representing it as your answer.
- I treat AI-based assistance, such as ChatGPT/Github/Copilot, the same way I treat collaboration with other people: you are welcome to talk about your ideas with other people, both inside and outside the class, as well as with AI-based assistants. However, all work you submit must be your own. You should never include in your assignment anything that was not written directly by you without proper citation (including quotation marks and in-line citation for direct quotes). **Including anything you did not write in your assignment without proper citation will be treated as an academic misconduct case.**

If you are unsure where the line is between collaborating with AI and copying from AI, I recommend the following heuristics:

- Never hit “Copy” within your conversation with an AI assistant. You can copy your own work into your conversation, but do not copy anything from the conversation back into your assignment. Instead, use your interaction with the AI assistant as a learning experience, then let your assignment reflect your improved understanding.

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- Do not have your assignment and the AI agent itself open on your device at the same time. Similar to above, use your conversation with the AI as a learning experience, then close the interaction down, open your assignment, and let your assignment reflect your revised knowledge. This heuristic includes avoiding using AI assistants that are directly integrated into your composition environment: just as you should not let a classmate write content or code directly into your submission, so also you should avoid using tools that directly add content to your submission.
- Do not use the AI agent to “clean up” your response. I expect your reflection response to be authentic and genuine for full credit.

Learning Outcomes

1. Identify the role of computers as an integral part of an information system.
2. Define terminology associated with information systems and computers.
3. Identify the various components of a computer system.
4. Demonstrate proficiency in the use of various business application packages.
5. Discuss various social issues associated with computers and information systems.

Instructor Objectives

Your instructor’s goal is to maximize the educational experience of those students who bring an appropriate, sincere effort and serious interest in the subject matter to the course. If you have any problems during the course of the semester, please talk to the instructor.

Course Requirements and Learning Assessment

<i>Knowledge</i>	Students are expected to demonstrate an <u>understanding</u> of computer hardware, software tools, information technology, and information systems that surpasses memorization. Quizzes, reflections, and examinations will be used to assess this level of learning.
<i>Techniques</i>	Students are expected to demonstrate the <u>application</u> of software tools and techniques. Training assignments, chapter homework, and laboratory examinations will assess this level of learning.

Assignments and Grading Scale

How Final Grades will be Determined (subject to change with notice)

<i>Assessment Mechanism</i>	<i>Percentages</i>
Pearson myLab IT Homework	25%
Pearson myLab IT Exams (x3)	30%
Pearson myLab IT Concepts Quizzes	10%
Pearson myLab IT Concepts Exams (x2)	25%
Brightspace Reflections	10%

Grading Scale (percentages)			
	93-100 A	90-92 A-	
87-89 B+	83-86 B	80-82 B-	
77-79 C+	73-76 C	70-72 C-	
67-69 D+	63-66 D	60-62 D-	0-59 F

Miscellaneous Notes and Comments

1. Your grade in this course will be determined by your performance on several essential criteria: participation reflections, homework assignments, homework exams, concepts quizzes, and concepts exams.

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2. Border-line grade cases will be evaluated objectively in descending order, using course grades to determine if the instructor feels that the student deserves the higher grade. In no case will one student with a lower percentage (i.e. 79.35%) be given a higher grade unless it has already been determined that all students with a higher percentage (i.e. 79.58%) will also be raised to a higher grade. NOTE: For example, a 79.99% is NOT automatically a “B-”, it is a “C+”.

Attendance Policies

Attendance, Preparation, and Courtesy Expectations and Policies

1. Since this course is online, it will be your responsibility to stay disciplined. It would be best for you to acquaint yourself with the calendar for the semester, and to make note of all due dates and exam dates. For the purposes of this course, being “present” means participating remotely and completing work assigned by the posted due dates unless you are ill or need to be absent for reasons excused by University regulations
2. You have the ability to work at your own pace, but there are due dates. Do not wait until the last minute to submit work. The due dates are firm and no late work will be accepted without a valid excuse that is discussed with the instructor in advance. There is an adequate amount of days to work on each assignment; therefore, **the assignments will not be available on Pearson myLab IT after the due date.**
3. When conflicts or absences can be anticipated, such as for many University-sponsored activities and religious observations, you should inform the instructor of the situation as far in advance as possible. For unanticipated or emergency absences when advance notification is not possible, contact the instructor as soon as possible by Purdue email or phone. For absences that do not fall under excused absence regulations (see below), this course follows the following procedures:
 - Unless it falls under the University excused absence regulations (see below), any work due should be submitted on time via our course Brightspace.
 - The most important consideration in any absence is how it will affect your achievement of the assignment objectives and the course learning outcomes.

For cases that fall under **excused absence regulations**, you or your representative should contact or go to the [Office of the Dean of Students \(ODOS\) website](#) to complete appropriate forms for instructor notification. Under academic regulations, excused absences may be granted by ODOS for cases of grief/bereavement, military service, jury duty, parenting leave, or certain types of medical care. The processes are detailed, so plan ahead.

Exam Policies

1. Students who miss an examination (for a valid reason) must make arrangements with the instructor to complete that work within one (1) week of returning to class. Failure to do so will result in a score of zero. It is the student’s responsibility to promptly notify the instructor and provide documentation with the reason for missing the exam.
2. A testout is available for this course during the fall and spring semesters. It is usually offered in both semesters during the first week of classes (usually on consecutive nights). It consists of two parts, a written examination over the lecture material (given first) and a laboratory examination portion over the use of software application packages. You must obtain at least 70% on each part to receive credit. You may only take the test once and you may not take the test if you have already received any grade in the course. See the course instructor for more details.

Course Schedule

The course schedule is included at the end of this syllabus, and it is also attached in Brightspace where it can be printed and used as a checklist.

Academic Integrity

Student Honor Pledge - *“As a boilermaker pursuing academic excellence, I pledge to be honest and true in all that I do. Accountable together - we are Purdue.”*

Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information is submitted the greater the opportunity for the university to investigate the concern. More details are available on the Academic Resources table on your Brightspace homepage.

1. All course materials are copyrighted by the instructor and may not be republished or posted for public viewing. Notes taken in class are considered derivative works and may not be republished or posted for public viewing.
2. **Pearson myLab IT has the ability to detect academic integrity violations.** Every assignment is analyzed, and any similarities are reported immediately to the instructor. While it is easy to share a file, it is just as easy to detect such sharing.
3. **All exams, quizzes, reflections, and homework assignments are individual work. This means that students are not to work collaboratively to complete exams, quizzes, reflections, and homework assignments.** The course is strictly individual and evaluated for violations of this policy.
4. Reflection Assignments: Plagiarizing another person's work as your own is also considered academic dishonesty as well as the direct use of **generative technology, such as ChatGPT**. When you do reference work, cite all work and utilize your own words when describing what knowledge you have gained. **You may not submit false or fabricated information, use the same academic work for credit in multiple courses, or share instructional content.**
5. Any form of cheating will result in a penalty up to automatic "F" grade for the course. All instances of cheating will be reported via the **OSRR Reporting Form**. An OSRR staff member will then contact you for appropriate disciplinary action. All cases of academic dishonesty are forwarded to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities (OSRR) for record-keeping purposes and consideration of other, appropriate disciplinary action.

Nondiscrimination Statement

Purdue University is committed to maintaining a community that recognizes and values the inherent worth and dignity of every person; fosters tolerance, sensitivity, understanding, and mutual respect among its members; and encourages each individual to strive to reach his or her potential. A hyperlink to Purdue's full Nondiscrimination Policy Statement is included in the Academic Resources table on your Brightspace homepage.

Accessibility

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247, as soon as possible. If the Disability Resource Center (DRC) has determined reasonable accommodations that you would like to utilize in my class, you must release your Course Accommodation Letter to me. Instructions on sharing your Course Accommodation Letter can be found by visiting: <https://www.purdue.edu/drc/students/course-accommodation-letter.php>. Additionally, you are strongly encouraged to contact me as soon as possible to discuss implementation of your accommodations.

Mental Health

If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try [Therapy Assistance Online \(TAO\)](#), a web and app-based mental health resource available courtesy of Purdue Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS). TAO is available to all students at any time by creating an account on the [TAO Connect website](#), or downloading the app from the App Store or Google Play. It offers free, confidential well-being resources through a self-guided program informed by psychotherapy research and strategies that may aid in overcoming anxiety, depression and other concerns. It provides accessible and effective resources including short videos, brief exercises, and self-reflection tools.

If you need support and information about options and resources, please contact or see the [Office of the Dean of Students](#). Call 765-494-1747. Hours of operation are M-F, 8 a.m.- 5 p.m.

If you find yourself struggling to find a healthy balance between academics, social life, stress, etc., sign up for free one-on-one virtual or in-person sessions in West Lafayette with a [Purdue Wellness Coach at RecWell](#). Student coaches can help you navigate through barriers and challenges toward your goals throughout the semester. Sign up is free and can be done on BoilerConnect.

If you're struggling and need mental health services: Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact [Counseling and Psychological Services \(CAPS\)](#) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS offices in [West Lafayette](#) or [Indianapolis](#).

Emergency Preparation

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond the instructor's control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the instructors or TAs via email or phone. You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.

See Purdue's Information on [Emergency Preparation and Planning](#). This website covers topics such as Severe Weather Guidance, Emergency Plans, and a place to sign up for the Emergency Warning Notification System. I encourage you to download and review the [Emergency Preparedness for Classrooms document](#).

Course Schedule on next page...

CNIT 13600 - Course Schedule for Spring 2026 (Subject to change)**PRINT THIS SCHEDULE AND USE IT AS A CHECKLIST**

Week	Topic	Reading Assignment	Homework Assignment	Due Date
Week 1 January 12	Get setup on Pearson's myLab IT	Read Syllabus and review Brightspace	☐ Read the syllabus ☐ Print this schedule ☐ Brightspace: Review the schedule, course introduction PowerPoint, and registration document ☐ Pearson myLab IT: Register for our course ☐ Brightspace: Complete the Course Introduction Quiz	Due Date: ASAP (Then begin working on Week 2 assignments)
Week 2 January 20	Technology in Action: Chapter 1	myLab IT: e-text Ch 1 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 1 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 1 reflection assignment	Due: January 27
	Word Chapter 1	Review Word Chapter 1 learning materials (both Brightspace and myLab IT)	☐ Brightspace: Review the help videos and help documents on how to complete the homework assignments successfully ☐ myLab IT: Complete Word Ch. 1 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
Week 3 January 26	Technology in Action: Chapter 2	myLab IT: e-text Ch 2 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 2 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 2 reflection assignment	Due: February 3
	Word Chapters 2 - 3	Review Word Chapters 2, 3 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Word Ch. 2 and 3 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
Week 4 February 2	Technology in Action: Chapter 3	myLab IT: e-text Ch 3 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 3 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 3 reflection assignment	Due: February 10
	Word Chapter 4	Review Word Chapter 4 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Word Ch. 4 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
Week 5 February 9	Word Exam	You may use your text and notes for the exam. You must also work alone!	☐ You will have <u>2</u> attempts at the exam, as you may rework the initial submission once.	Due: February 17
	Excel Chapter 1	Review Excel Chapter 1 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Excel Ch. 1 Homework (resubmit as needed)	

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Week	Topic	Reading Assignment	Homework Assignment	Due Date
Week 6 February 16	Technology in Action: Chapter 4	myLab IT: e-text Ch 4 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 4 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 4 reflection assignment	Due: February 24
	Excel Chapters 2 - 3	Review Excel Chapters 2, 3 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Excel Ch. 2 and 3 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
Week 7 February 23	Technology in Action: Chapter 5	myLab IT: e-text Ch 5 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 5 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 5 reflection assignment	Due: March 3
	Excel Chapter 4	Review Excel Chapter 4 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Excel Ch. 4 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
Week 8 March 2	Concepts Exam #1 (Chapters 1-5)	You may use your text and notes for the exam, but it is a timed exam.	☐ There is one attempt for this exam and it is timed at one hour.	Due: March 10
	Excel Exam	You may use your text and notes for the exam. You must also work alone!	☐ You will have <u>2</u> attempts at the exam, as you may rework the initial submission once.	
Week 9 March 9	Technology in Action: Chapter 7	myLab IT: e-text Ch 7 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 7 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 7 reflection assignment	Due: March 24
	Powerpoint Chapters 1 - 2	Review Powerpoint Chapters 1, 2 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Powerpoint Ch. 1 and 2 Homework (resubmit as needed)	
March 16	Spring Break			
Week 10 March 23	Technology in Action: Chapter 8	myLab IT: e-text Ch 8 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 8 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 8 reflection assignment	Due: March 31
	Powerpoint Chapters 3 - 4	Review Powerpoint Chapters 3, 4 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Powerpoint Ch. 3 and 4 Homework (resubmit as needed)	

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Week	Topic	Reading Assignment	Homework Assignment	Due Date
Week 11 March 30	Technology in Action: Chapter 9	myLab IT: e-text Ch 9 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 9 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 9 reflection assignment	Due: April 7
	PPT Exam	You may use your text and notes for the exam. You must also work alone!	☐ You will have <u>2</u> attempts at the exam, as you may rework the initial submission once.	
Week 12 April 6	Technology in Action: Chapter 10	myLab IT: e-text Ch 10 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 10 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 10 reflection assignment	Due: April 14
	Access Chapters 1 - 2	Review Access Chapter 1, 2 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Access Ch. 1, 2 Simulator and Homework	
Week 13 April 13	Technology in Action: Chapter 11	myLab IT: e-text Ch 11 Technology in Action (TIA)	☐ myLab IT: Chapter 11 quiz ☐ Brightspace: Chapter 11 reflection assignment	Due: April 21
	Access Chapter 3	Review Access Chapter 3 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Access Ch. 3 Simulator and Homework	
Week 14 April 20	Concepts Exam #2 (Chapters 7-11)	You may use your text and notes for the exam, but it is a timed exam.	☐ Timed exam with one attempt	Due: April 28
	Access Chapter 4	Review Access Chapter 4 learning materials	☐ myLab IT: Complete Access Ch. 4 Simulator and Homework	
Week 15 April 27	Once you have submitted the Concepts Exam #2 and Access Chapter 4, the course is complete as there is no Final Exam.			
Have a restful break!				